Chapter-wise Detailed Notes — Citizenship: meaning, features, genesis, development, acquisition and loss

Introduction to Political Theory · Unit 3 · Chapter Citizenship: meaning, features, genesis, development, acquisition and loss

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Chapter Study Notes

Learning focus

Citizenship is a recognised legal and political membership of a state, normally carrying rights, duties and a claim to participation.

1. Modern citizenship developed alongside the modern state, constitutional government and struggles to extend membership beyond privileged groups.

2. Civil, political and social dimensions of citizenship are often distinguished: legal freedoms, political participation and access to conditions for social welfare.

3. Citizenship may be acquired by birth, descent, registration, naturalisation or other procedures defined by domestic law. Loss or renunciation depends on the relevant legal framework.

4. Contemporary debates concern migration, dual citizenship, statelessness, equal membership and the difference between formal legal status and effective participation.

Revision checklist

■ Can I define the key concept in my own words?

■ Can I explain its main features and distinguish it from related concepts?

■ Can I support an argument with a relevant example, thinker or constitutional provision?

■ Can I discuss at least one limitation or counterargument?